who have broken through the cycle of birth and death *(Saṃsāra)* by following the eight-fold path of discipline which stresses right conduct *(Śila)*, right knowledge *(Prajnā)*, and right concentration *(Samādhī)*.

The two schools, *Hīnayāna* (small wheel) and *Mahāyāna* (large wheel), into which Buddhism gradually split itself both entertain the theory of momentariness *(Kṣana-bhangvāda)*. At every moment, everything is changing into something else, and identity is only an illusion. Even the Self is defined as a continuous succession of ideas. Facts of memory and moral responsibility can be explained by similarity which the different appearances of the Self bear to one another. External objects are, therefore, a series *(Santāna)* of unique particulars. Universals are dismissed as ideal superimpositions upon the object. This refusal to admit unity and universality as real is in direct opposition to Jainism.

Mahāyāna Buddhism is represented by two idealistic schools—the *Yogācāras* and the *Mādhyamikas*. The *Yogācāras* whose *Vijnāna-vāda* (theory of the sole reality of ideas) maintains that knowledge points to no objects beyond itself and explains that an object (including the Self) is a mere series of ideas resembles closely the modern subjective idealists. The *Mādhyamikas*, who deny both the external objects and the Self, are like the modern nihilists. The latter school is also called the *Śūnyavāda*, or the doctrine of the void, which, however, does grant a sort of reality to the subject and object and does seem to suggest that the ultimate reality is called *Śūnya* because it is incomprehensible and not because it is non-existent.

In spite of common ethical practice, the ethical teaching of the two schools differs in some respects. While the Hīnayāna scheme of individual perfection is virtually the same as in canonical Buddhism, Mahāyāna Buddhism maintains that the ideal man or the *Bodhisattva* attains his own perfection through social channels.

THE SIX SYSTEMS

While later Indian thought seems to diverge from the original source and to diversify itself into a number of conflicting systems, perhaps, it would not be correct to regard them as independent schools of thought. They are more in the nature of an elaboration of different aspects of the same thought. The six well-known systems of Indian philosophy are an amplification of the monistic, the dualistic, and the pluralistic trends of the traditional Hindu thought. We shall briefly note them in pairs.